



3. Carefully lift the motherboard out of the case, handling it by the edges to avoid damaging sensitive components.
4. Store the motherboard in an anti-static bag or a safe location.

### Step 14: Clean

With your PC fully disassembled, take the opportunity to clean and inspect each component. Use compressed air to blow out dust, and a lint-free cloth with isopropyl alcohol to clean surfaces.

Check for signs of damage or wear, such as burnt components, leaking capacitors, or damaged connectors. Replace any damaged components as necessary.

### What are the risks of disassembling your PC?

Disassembling your own PC can be a valuable skill for troubleshooting, upgrading, or maintaining your computer. However, there are potential risks associated with the process, especially for those inexperienced with handling computer hardware. Some of these risks include:

1. **Static electricity:** Static discharge can damage sensitive electronic components, leading to permanent damage or failure. Wearing an anti-static wrist strap and grounding yourself before handling components can help minimize this risk.
2. **Physical damage:** Improper handling or excessive force can cause physical damage to components, such as breaking connectors, bending pins, or cracking circuit boards. Handle components gently and by their edges to reduce the likelihood of damage.
3. **Lost or misplaced parts:** Small screws, connectors, and other components can be easily misplaced during disassembly. Losing these parts can make reassembly difficult and potentially cause issues with your PC's functionality. Keep track of all parts and organize them carefully during the process.
4. **Incorrect reassembly:** Failing to correctly reassemble

your PC can result in poor performance, instability, or component damage. Double-check all connections, and consult the photos you took during disassembly or your computer's manual to ensure proper reassembly.

5. **Voiding warranty:** Disassembling your PC may void your manufacturer's warranty, especially if the process involves breaking warranty seals. If your computer is still under warranty, consult the terms and conditions before attempting any disassembly.
6. **Personal injury:** While rare, there is a potential for personal injury during disassembly, particularly if you're dealing with sharp edges or electrical components. Exercise caution and wear appropriate protective gear, such as gloves, when necessary.
7. **Data loss:** Disassembling your PC carries the risk of data loss, especially if you accidentally damage storage devices or improperly handle components. Make sure to back up important data before starting the disassembly process.

### Why should you learn to disassemble your PC?

Learning to disassemble your PC can be a valuable skill for several reasons, including:

1. **Troubleshooting:** Understanding how to disassemble your PC can help you diagnose and fix hardware-related issues more effectively. By examining each component, you can identify the source of problems, such as faulty connections, overheating, or damaged parts.
2. **Upgrading:** As your computing needs change, you may want to upgrade your PC with new components, such as a more powerful graphics card, additional memory, or a larger storage drive. Knowing how to disassemble your PC allows you to perform these upgrades yourself, saving money on professional installation fees.
3. **Maintenance:** Regular maintenance, such as cleaning dust from components and ensuring proper airflow, can help prolong the life of your PC and maintain optimal performance. Disassembling your PC enables you to perform this maintenance and keep your computer in good working order.
4. **Customisation:** Building a custom PC or modifying an existing one often requires disassembly and reassembly. Learning how to disassemble your PC can pave the way for more advanced customization projects and help you create a computer tailored to your specific needs.
5. **Cost savings:** By learning how to disassemble your PC and perform upgrades, repairs, or maintenance yourself, you can save money that would otherwise be spent on professional services or purchasing a new computer.
6. **Independence:** By learning to disassemble your PC, you become more self-reliant and less dependent on professional services. This independence can be empowering